News digest

Ivory Coast facing UN sanctions

France is pushing to win passage of a UN resolution that seeks an arms embargo and other penalties against the Ivory Coast. France s UN ambassador, Jean-Marc de la Sabliere, hopes for a vote early this week.

Putin in Brazil for space talks

Russian president Vladimir Putin visits Brazil for talks on its space programme and the sale of fighter planes.

Committee Recommends Abusive Clergy Ban (AP)

AP - A committee overseeing a review of the child protection plan adopted by Roman Catholic bishops has recommended preserving a ban on church work for clerics who molest young people, according to a document the panel has sent to all U.S. bishops.

French minister returns empty handed

Leaving behind two French reporters still held hostage in Iraq, France s foreign minister headed home from the Middle East but said they were still believed to be alive and that efforts to free them would continue.

5 dead in Dubai airport accident

DUBAI - A steel mesh wall collapsed on workers building a multi-billion-dollar extension to Dubai s international airport yesterday, leaving five dead and 12 injured, authorities said.

Lebanon PM Resigns, Says Will Not Head New Govt.

BEIRUT (Reuters) - Lebanon's Prime Minister Rafik al-Hariri resigned Wednesday and said he would not form a new government, following a widely opposed constitutional change to keep the Syrian-backed president in office.